"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, mostly sunny, breezy, warm, high 69. **Tonight,** clear, seasonably cool, low 47. **Tomorrow,** more sun than clouds, noticeably cooler, high 59. Weather map is on Page B7.

VOL. CLXXVI .... No. 61,053 © 2026 The New York Times Company FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00



MARCELO DEL POZO/REUTERS

Sorrow, and a Swirl of Questions
Moments of silence for Spain's rail crash victims Thursday in Seville. After another tragedy, scrutiny falls on a system's safety. Page A8.

Alaska Governor Orders Investigation of Peltola

Looking at Campaign's Drafting of Spoilers for a Senate Race

By KELLEN BROWNING and ANNA GRIFFIN

Alaska's governor on Wednesday night said he was ordering an investigation into whether Mary Peltola's campaign for Senate should face criminal charges or civil penalties over its role in recruiting candidates to draw votes from the state's Republican incumbent.

The announcement by Gov. Mike Dunleavy, a Republican, followed a New York Times report detailing the Peltola campaign's involvement in recruiting a retiree named Dan J. Sullivan to enter the race against Senator Dan S. Sullivan.

"Deliberately tricking voters into casting their ballots for someone else strikes at the integrity of our elections," he said in a post on X. "Anyone or any organization found to have broken the law must be held accountable."

Earlier in the day, President Trump demanded that Ms. Peltola, a Democrat, be removed from the ballot and prosecuted without explaining what crime, if any, was committed.

"They said they didn't do it, and they did do it, and they got caught," Mr. Trump told reporters on his way to a rally in Ohio, describing the Democratic effort as "voter fraud at the highest level."

The secret plan involved senior advisers to both the Peltola campaign and the top campaign committee supporting Senate Democrats. The retiree, who is from a small Alaskan fishing village, was recruited because he shared the Republican incumbent's first and last name.

Both Sullivans will appear on the ballot on Tuesday alongside Ms. Peltola and a fourth candi-

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DAVID GUTTENFELDER/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Workers in Kherson on Thursday taking advantage of a cease-fire to spruce up the city square.

'Finally It's Quiet' in Frontline City, for a Moment

UKRAINE DISPATCH

By SIOBHÁN O'GRADY and LIUBOV SHOLUDKO

KHERSON, Ukraine — In the eight months since he was born in Ukraine's frontline city of Kherson, Davyd has never been more than five minutes away from his home, kept inside by his parents because of relentless attacks by Russian glide bombs, missiles and drones.

Davyd got his first glimpse of a larger, safer world on Wednesday, when a local cease-fire announced by the United States' first lady, Melania Trump, let his parents take him on his longest-ever walk. With Davyd bundled up in a Mickey Mouse hat and fleece panda pants, the family spent more than an hour strolling streets normally threatened by Russian artillery and drones, basking in the October sun without the usual fears that their child might at any moment be killed.

Davyd shook his rattle as the family strolled, eyes wide at his new surroundings.

"We wish it were like this all the time," Davyd's mother, Oleksandra, 27, said as they passed the bombed-out governor's office on the city's main street, covered in nets to catch Russian drones. Oleksandra, like many residents, spoke on the condition that she be identified only by her first name. She fears retribution

Continued on Page A6

In Grim Mood, Trump Awaits The Midterms

Stewing in West Wing With Anxious Aides

By KATIE ROGERS

WASHINGTON — President Trump's private dining room, located just off the Oval Office, is where he goes to watch television, make phone calls and sift through stacks of printed-out news articles and documents that eat up most of the space. A spot has been cleared for Natalie Harp, a devoted aide who now works out of that room when she is not seated behind the president at his desk.

Elsewhere, Bill Pulte, a top federal housing official and purveyor of A.I.-generated images and memes that make their way to the president's social media feed, spends some of his time making posters. He recently made one of Senator Jon Husted of Ohio, a Republican whose backside Mr. Trump has admired, for the president to display while riding aboard Air Force One.

Amid the loyalists, news clippings, poster boards and pieces of art made by his fans is an increasingly unpredictable president staring down the possibility that the Republican Party could lose both chambers of Congress in next week's elections.

Many G.O.P. candidates in tight races have tried to distance themselves from Mr. Trump's policies, his behavior and the widespread allegations of self-dealing in his administration. Behind the scenes, some political advisers and outside Republican groups have warned the president's aides that Mr. Trump could do more harm than good by holding rallies in battleground states with uncomfortably close races, according to people with knowledge of the conversations.

But the president, under pressure and angry with naysayers, has dismissed polls that reflect his unpopularity, and has raged against unflattering stories that plunge him into a dark mood. Determined to win by turning the midterm season into a referendum on himself, he is headlining rallies around the country all week.

Mr. Trump remains convinced that his dominant place in the Republican Party is enough to mitigate a tough political climate. But a grim mood has set in around the White House, which has been rocked by turnover, tension among internal factions and anxiety over what happens should Republicans lose legislative control in Washington, according to 16 current and former administration officials and allies of Mr.

Continued on Page A12

U.S. Broadens Voting Inquiry In California

By DEVLIN BARRETT and SHAWN HUBLER

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has opened a criminal investigation in its intensifying campaign to prove thousands of noncitizens are on California's voter rolls, issuing federal grand jury subpoenas to local election officials, according to people with knowledge of the matter and copies of subpoenas obtained by The New York Times.

The move escalates the Justice Department's pressure on the most populous state as the administration seeks to tighten its grip on the midterm elections by making unsubstantiated claims that large numbers of illegal voters are on the rolls. A day earlier, a federal judge resoundingly rejected the Trump administration's bid to block the state from counting the votes of some 20,000 people it says are likely noncitizens, even though studies have found such fraud is very rare.

The new subpoenas are part of the administration's broader ef-

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ECONOMY GROWS AT FASTEST PACE SINCE LAST YEAR

CONTRASTS WITH MOOD

Consumer Spending and A.I. Boom Give a Jolt, but Inflation Nags

By BEN CASSELMAN

U.S. economic growth was robust over the summer, as businesses poured money into artificial intelligence and consumers kept spending despite high prices that have soured their mood ahead of midterm elections next week.

Gross domestic product, the broadest measure of goods and services produced in the country, increased at a 3.4 percent annual rate in the third quarter, adjusted for inflation, the Bureau of Economic Analysis said Thursday.

That was an acceleration from the 2.2 percent rate in the spring, and was the fastest growth in a year. Consumer spending, which accounts for more than two-thirds of economic output, grew at a 3.8 percent rate.

The strong spending and growth figures contrast with the poor marks that many voters are giving the economy as they head to the ballot box for next week's midterm elections. Polls consistently show that Americans are frustrated with the high cost of living and hold President Trump and congressional Republicans responsible for failing to deliver on their promises to improve affordability.

Those frustrations are grounded in reality. Consumer prices were up 3.5 percent in the third quarter from a year earlier, driven in part by high gas prices that are the direct result of Mr. Trump's decision to go to war with Iran. Americans are increasingly dipping into their savings to keep up with rising costs. Households, in the aggregate, saved just 4.1 percent of their after-tax income in the third quarter, the lowest rate in nearly four years. After-tax income, adjusted for inflation, rose in the third quarter as a whole but fell in September.

"The data on the economy are something to celebrate, but they look better on paper than they feel to most Americans," said Diane Swonk, chief economist for KPMG, the accounting firm.

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INFLATION A Fed December rate increase is expected. Other moves will depend on the data. PAGE B1

Nvidia Chief Seen as Target of Chinese Spy Plot

*This article is by **Jonathan Swan**, **Maggie Haberman**, **Ana Swanson**, **Paul Mozur**, **Tripp Mickle** and **Julian E. Barnes**.*

American spy agencies had gathered striking intelligence.

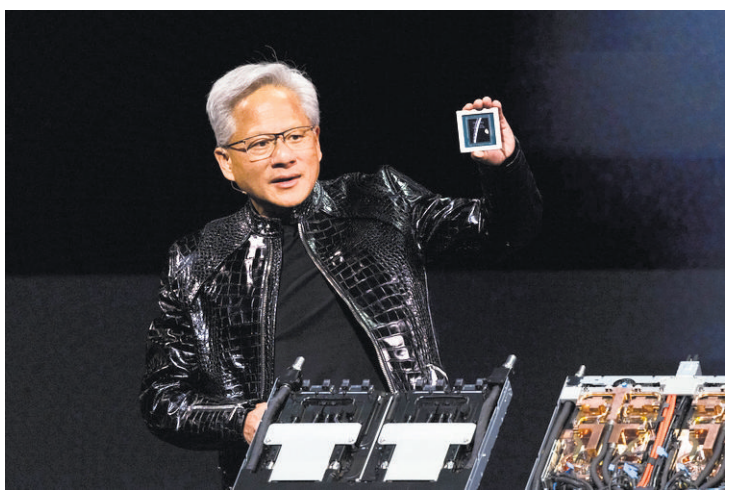
A top executive at a Singapore-based data center company was under scrutiny for possibly steering advanced Nvidia A.I. chips to China. And now American officials had concluded that she was a Chinese intelligence asset, funneling information to Beijing.

But what came next was even more alarming. Surveillance of the executive, Alice Huang or Huang Le, a Chinese citizen, revealed that she had developed a close relationship with Jensen Huang, Nvidia's chief executive.

For years, Washington has worked to deny China the technology needed to match or surpass the United States in the intense global competition for superiority in artificial intelligence. The discovery that Beijing was getting reports from someone with direct access to Mr. Huang, one of the most powerful figures in the A.I. revolution as well as an influential ally of President Trump's, set off alarms at the White House.

Roughly a year ago, Mr. Trump was briefed about the intelligence findings, which have not been previously reported, and chose not to do anything with the information. Mr. Trump has been wary of disrupting Nvidia's chip sales, which are helping to drive the economy and the stock market, and of further complicating the trading rela-

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MIKAYLA WHITMORE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Jensen Huang has been influential on White House tech policy.

SPORTS B8-11

Kansas City Examines Flaws
A 20-3 loss raised questions about the team's receiver depth and Chris Jones's underperformance. PAGE B10

Winning the Brewers' Way
The franchise's first World Series title was a fitting outcome for a team that marched to its own beat. PAGE B8



INTERNATIONAL A4-9

In Israeli Spotlight
The Arab parties, after their best-ever showing in the elections on Sunday, seem to be the opposition's only hope of toppling Benjamin Netanyahu. PAGE A7

Mexico's War on Seaweed
The country's navy is fighting a massive sargassum bloom that dumps thousands of tons of seaweed onto Caribbean beaches daily. PAGE A4

A Little Help From the U.S.
Flávio Bolsonaro, who faces criminal inquiries in Brazil, was helped by President Trump and his aides in fleeing his country and entering the U.S. PAGE A9

NATIONAL A10-19, 22

New Focus on Omar Marriage
The inquiry into Representative Ilhan Omar includes whether she entered into a sham marriage with a man suspected of being her brother. PAGE A22

A Claim for an Arch's Approval
The Trump administration says that the monument fulfills the "design intent" of a 1920s plan and that Congress effectively authorized it then. PAGE A10

Golf Project Tests Judge
The administration says it will meet President Trump's Nov. 15 deadline to close East Potomac Park to build a championship golf course. PAGE A11

WEEKEND ARTS C1-10

Pulling Some Costly Strings
How can your average virtuoso afford a $30 million viola? Some very generous people are making it happen. PAGE C1

Her Own Detective Story
At the Guggenheim, an exhibition by the photographer Taryn Simon traces the career of a retired F.B.I. agent. PAGE C1



BUSINESS B1-6

Life Feeling Too Expensive?
Affordability will most likely be a big issue for younger voters. Here's a look at why people are feeling pinched. PAGE B5

Lagarde Plans to Step Down
Christine Lagarde is cutting short her turbulent eight-year term as the European Central Bank's president. PAGE B1

OPINION A20-21

Lydia Polgreen PAGE A20